

RetroSpectrum Keyboard Shortcut Reference

August 14, 2026

Abstract

This document summarizes the non-obvious keyboard shortcuts implemented by the supplied RetroSpectrum source. It covers global navigation and the Map Dashboard, RetroSpectrum live spectrum, Analysis, Classification, Decode, Case Management, and Correlation workstations. Ordinary text-editing keys are omitted unless their behavior is workstation-specific or materially different from normal text editing.

Contents

1	Scope and Conventions	2
2	Global Navigation and Application Shortcuts	2
3	Map Dashboard	2
4	RetroSpectrum Live Spectrum Workstation	3
5	Analysis Workstation	3
5.1	Primary Analysis Shortcuts	3
5.2	Context-Sensitive Analysis Controls	4
6	Classification Workstation	4
7	Decode Workstation	5
7.1	Primary Decode Shortcuts	5
7.2	Bitstream Classifier Text Controls	5
8	Case Management Workstation	5
8.1	Graph Editing Shortcuts	5
8.2	Case Management Context Controls	6
9	Correlation Workstation	6
10	Compact Shortcut Reference	6

1 Scope and Conventions

The shortcuts in this reference describe the integrated application behavior in the supplied source archive. The most important dispatch rules are:

- Function keys **F1-F7** select top-level workstations even while a text-entry control is active.
- Number keys **1-7** provide the same top-level navigation only when no text-entry control is active.
- The main event loop handles **Esc** before workstation-specific event handlers. In the current integrated build, **Esc** therefore exits RetroSpectrum rather than acting as a local cancel/close shortcut inside a workstation dialog.
- **Ctrl+D** is the explicit return-to-Dashboard shortcut used by the workstation modes.
- Keyboard-assisted mouse gestures such as **Ctrl+drag**, **Shift+drag**, and **N+drag** are included because they expose analysis features that are otherwise difficult to discover.

The source basis is the supplied **RetroSpectrum.c**, **MapDashboard.c**, and the five workstation modules for Analysis, Classification, Decode, Case Management, and Correlation.

2 Global Navigation and Application Shortcuts

These shortcuts are dispatched above the individual workstation handlers.

Shortcut	Context	Action
F1	Anywhere	Open the Map Dashboard.
F2	Anywhere	Open the RetroSpectrum live spectrum workstation.
F3	Anywhere	Open the Analysis Workstation.
F4	Anywhere	Open the Classification Workstation.
F5	Anywhere	Open the Decode Workstation.
F6	Anywhere	Open the Case Management Workstation.
F7	Anywhere	Open the Correlation Workstation.
1 - 7	No text entry active	Same mapping as F1-F7 : Map, RetroSpectrum, Analysis, Classification, Decode, Case Management, Correlation.
Ctrl+D	Workstation mode	Exit the current workstation and return to the Map Dashboard.
Ctrl+L	Anywhere in main application	Request logout and return to authentication.
F11	Anywhere in main application	Toggle fullscreen mode.
Esc	Anywhere in integrated build	Exit RetroSpectrum. This global handler takes precedence over local dialog Esc handlers in the current source.

3 Map Dashboard

Shortcut	Context	Action
Left Ctrl / Right Ctrl	A case is selected	Clear the selected case and exit the case-detail/sidebar view. Pressing either Control key by itself performs this action.
Ctrl+V	Case image path field active	Paste a filesystem path into the case-image path field.
Enter	Case image path field active	Upload/apply the case image at the entered path.
Enter	Case RGB color field active	Save the edited case color value.
Q	Dashboard active	Quit RetroSpectrum through the Dashboard event handler.

The global **F1-F7**, **1-7**, **Ctrl+L**, **F11**, and **Esc** rules still apply while the Dashboard is active.

4 RetroSpectrum Live Spectrum Workstation

Shortcut	Context	Action
Tab	No modal workstation active	Cycle the editable live-spectrum fields in this order: Center MHz, Sample MS/s, Display MHz, Gain A, Gain B, FPS, Rows/Frame.
Enter	Live-spectrum input editing	Apply the current input values to the SDR/display configuration.
G	No live-spectrum field active	Enter the Analysis Workstation. When pressed from Analysis, G returns to the live RetroSpectrum view.
H	No live-spectrum field active	Enter the Classification Workstation. From Classification, H exits back to the live RetroSpectrum view.
Q	No live-spectrum field active	Quit RetroSpectrum.
Ctrl+D	No live-spectrum field active	Return to the Map Dashboard.

5 Analysis Workstation

5.1 Primary Analysis Shortcuts

Shortcut	Context	Action
Ctrl+Left	No text field active	Switch to the previous Analysis workspace.
Ctrl+Right	No text field active	Switch to the next Analysis workspace.
Ctrl+drag	Greyscale spectrogram	Select a frequency band and apply the frequency filter when the drag completes.
Shift+drag	Greyscale spectrogram	Select a time interval/column range on the spectrogram.
N+drag	Magnitude or Instantaneous Frequency graph	Mark a noise region for the active noise filter.
Backspace / Delete	No text field active	Clear the current Analysis filter selection.
R	No text field active	Clear the currently loaded recording and rescan the recording directory.
Up / Down	No text field active	Move the selected recording up/down in the recording list.
Enter / Space	No text field active	Open the currently selected recording.
C	Analysis selection available	Export the current Analysis selection into Classification and prefill file name, frequency, bandwidth, start time, and end time.
G	No text field active	Leave Analysis and return to the live RetroSpectrum workstation.
H	No text field active	Switch from Analysis to Classification.

5.2 Context-Sensitive Analysis Controls

Shortcut	Context	Action
Tab / Shift+Tab	Signal Settings menu	Move forward/backward through the signal metadata/crop fields.
Shift+Left / Shift+Right	Signal Settings filename field	Extend or shrink the filename text selection.
Enter	Signal Settings menu	Apply the crop/signal settings and close the menu when validation succeeds.
Tab / Shift+Tab	Transmit configuration dialog	Move forward/backward through transmission configuration fields.
Enter	Transmit configuration dialog	Submit the transmission settings.
Enter	Transmission authorization dialog	Authorize the transmission using the entered password.
Enter	10-thread IQ loading prompt	Toggle multithreaded IQ loading.
Enter	Delete Recording confirmation	Confirm deletion of the selected recording.

6 Classification Workstation

Shortcut	Context	Action
R	No field active	Rescan available recordings.
Up / Down	No field active	Select the previous/next recording and load it into the classification fields.
Enter / Space	No field active	Save/append the current classification record.
Tab	No field active	Begin keyboard editing at the Case Number field.
Tab	Field active	Advance through editable non-dropdown fields.
Ctrl+A	Field active	Select all text in the active field.
Ctrl+V	Latitude or Longitude active	Paste clipboard text into the coordinate field. Clipboard paste is intentionally limited to these coordinate fields in the main classification form.
Shift+Arrow keys	Field active	Extend the active text selection; vertical selection movement is supported in Notes.
Enter	Notes active	Insert a newline in Notes instead of leaving the field.
Enter	Other text field active	Finish editing the active field.
G	No field active	Switch directly to the Analysis Workstation.
H	No field active	Exit Classification and return to the live RetroSpectrum workstation.

7 Decode Workstation

7.1 Primary Decode Shortcuts

Shortcut	Context	Action
R	No numeric field active	Rescan decoder input files.
Enter	No numeric field active, decoder tab	Run the selected recording through the selected decoder.
Enter	No numeric field active, Preamble tab	Start the preamble search worker instead of running the normal decoder.
C	No numeric field active	Clear the bitstream, classifier assignments, ASCII output, scroll position, selection, and bit-edit state.
Ctrl+C	Decode workstation	Copy the current bitstream to the system clipboard.
Ctrl+A	Bitstream edit mode	Select the entire decoded bitstream.
Enter	Bitstream edit mode	Close bitstream edit mode and clear the bit selection.

7.2 Bitstream Classifier Text Controls

Shortcut	Context	Action
Ctrl+A	Classifier document-name field	Select the entire document name.
Ctrl+C	Classifier document-name field	Copy the selected document-name text to the clipboard.
Shift+Left / Shift+Right	Classifier document-name field	Extend or shrink the document-name selection. Shift+Home and Shift+End extend to the beginning/end.
Enter	New-label field	Finish editing and add the custom classifier label.
Enter	RGB field	Finish editing and apply the custom classifier RGB value.

8 Case Management Workstation

8.1 Graph Editing Shortcuts

Shortcut	Context	Action
Ctrl+Z	Case graph	Undo the most recent graph change.
Ctrl+S	Case graph	Save the current case-management document.
Ctrl+O	Case graph	Open the saved case-graph file search menu.
N	No field active	Create a new Task block.
C	No field active	Create a new Case metadata block.
L	No field active	Toggle link mode. When enabled, click a source block and then a destination block.
D	No field active	Duplicate the currently selected block or selected block set.
S	No field active, without Ctrl	Cycle the selected block's Status through the configured status options.
Delete / Backspace	No field active	Delete the selected link, or delete the selected block/block set.
Shift+Click / Ctrl+Click	Block on canvas	Toggle that block in the current multi-selection instead of replacing the selection.
Shift+box select / Ctrl+box select	Canvas rectangle selection	Add blocks inside the rectangle to the existing block selection instead of replacing it.

8.2 Case Management Context Controls

Shortcut	Context	Action
Ctrl+V	Task Description field or expanded Description editor	Paste clipboard text into the description.
Ctrl+V	Case metadata search/name/description editor	Paste clipboard text into the active metadata text control.
Up / Down	Assigned-user dropdown active	Move through matching users.
Enter	Assigned-user dropdown active	Choose the highlighted/matching user.
Enter	Description field active	Insert a newline rather than closing the field.
R	Saved graph search menu	Rescan available case-graph files.
R	Source-file search menu	Rescan source files available for assignment to the selected task.

9 Correlation Workstation

Shortcut	Context	Action
Enter	No weight field active	Start the correlation worker using the current selected recording and settings.
R	Idle	Rescan recordings. Disabled while correlation work is running.
F	Idle	Open the correlation file-search popup.
Up / Down	Idle with recordings available	Select the previous/next recording; selection wraps at the ends.
Tab	Weight field active	Apply the current weight value and activate the next of the four weight fields.
Enter	Weight field active	Apply the weight inputs and leave weight editing.
Up / Down	Correlation file-search popup	Move through filtered search results.
Enter	Correlation file-search popup	Select the current filtered recording and close the search popup.

10 Compact Shortcut Reference

- **Top-level navigation:** F1-F7 always select Map, RetroSpectrum, Analysis, Classification, Decode, Case Management, and Correlation; 1-7 do the same when no text field is active.
- **Application:** Ctrl+D Dashboard, Ctrl+L logout, F11 fullscreen, Esc exit application in the current integrated event loop.
- **Analysis:** Ctrl+Left/Right workspaces, Ctrl+drag frequency filter, Shift+drag time selection, N+drag noise region, C export to Classification.
- **Classification:** R rescan, Enter/Space save classification, Ctrl+A select field text, Ctrl+V coordinate paste, G Analysis, H live RetroSpectrum.
- **Decode:** Enter run decode/preamble search, C clear bitstream, Ctrl+C copy bitstream, Ctrl+A select all bitstream while editing.
- **Case Management:** Ctrl+Z undo, Ctrl+S save, Ctrl+O open, N task, C case block, L link mode, D duplicate, S cycle status.
- **Correlation:** Enter run, R rescan, F search, Up/Down recording selection, Tab next weight.